

# Pollinator Network Draft and Build

*Draft a pollinator habitat that works all season, not just on the prettiest day.*

**Win condition:** Highest pollinator support across spring, summer, and fall using native and clumping logic.

## THE SCIENCE YOU ARE USING

**Networks, not single plants.** Pollinators need food across the whole season, not just one bloom. A good habitat is a network: plants that flower in spring, summer, and fall, matched to the pollinators that visit them. Gaps in the calendar starve the system.

**Native and clumping logic.** Native plants tend to support local pollinators best, and planting in clumps helps insects find and work them efficiently. You draft plant and pollinator cards, then place them on a grid under these constraints.

## HOW TO BUILD AND RUN IT

- 1 Draft your cards.** Pick plant and pollinator cards. Note bloom season and which pollinators each plant supports.
- 2 Cover every season.** Lay out plants so something blooms in spring, summer, and fall. Use season tokens to check coverage.
- 3 Apply native and clumping rules.** Favor natives and group same plants in clumps so pollinators forage efficiently.
- 4 Connect the network.** Make sure each pollinator has food across its active months, not just one.
- 5 Defend the design.** Explain how your grid supports the most pollinators across the whole season.

**Safety:** No live insects required. Students only handle cards and grid materials. Allergy: None.

## MATERIALS

|                  |          |
|------------------|----------|
| Plant cards      | set      |
| Pollinator cards | set      |
| Grid boards      | per team |
| Stickers         | shared   |
| Markers          | shared   |
| Season tokens    | shared   |

## YOUR PLAN AND DATA

Clean, complete data is worth as much as a fast result.

**Prediction (what will work best, and why):**

**The ONE variable we are testing:**

Baseline result:

After redesign:

DEFEND YOUR DESIGN

What evidence made you change your design?

If you ran it again, what is the ONE thing you would change?

HOW YOU SCORE (100 POINTS)

| Scoring criterion         | Points |
|---------------------------|--------|
| Seasonal coverage         | 30     |
| Pollinator fit            | 25     |
| Native and clumping logic | 20     |
| Layout clarity            | 15     |
| Defense                   | 10     |
| Total                     | 100    |